Subtract mixed numbers with related parts

I can… rename related denominators and a whole to subtract mixed numbers.

Start with 3 1/2 – 1 3/4

3 1/2 = 3 2/4 = 2 6/4

Subtract matching units

2 6/4 – 1 3/4 = 1 3/4

Explain and check

One whole becomes four fourths. Its value stays the same.

1 3/4 + 1 3/4 = 3 1/2